

M01 PROTECTED PRACTICE REVIEW

Open only after a genuine saved attempt

After repair: close this review and solve a changed fresh retry.

EF1 review - Meet Excel: Workbook, Worksheet and Grid

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

You can name workbook vs worksheet correctly, the requested tabs exist, E9 on Summary contains Ready after reopen, and you can point to Ribbon, Name Box and Formula Bar.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Open a workbook, switch between two worksheets, click C5, confirm C5 in the Name Box, type North, and inspect the value in the Formula Bar.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

Excel is useful only when the workbook remains understandable, change-safe and auditable. The goal is not to memorize clicks; it is to produce a result that still makes sense when the data or question changes.

4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If typing lands in the wrong place, stop and verify the active-cell address in the Name Box before editing. If you are on the wrong tab, switch worksheets before changing data.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF2 review - Enter, Edit, Save and Structure Data

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

There is exactly one header row, one meaning per column, consistent row grain, no blank decorative rows inside the block, and the raw concept is preserved separately from later calculations.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Build a six-column order block: Order ID, Order Date, Region, Product, Quantity, Unit Price. Enter five records and state: one row = one order line.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

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4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If your sheet has titles/totals mixed into raw records, move reporting text outside the data block. If you cannot state what one row means, stop before formulas and define the grain first.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF3 review - Data Types, Number Formats and Clean Layout

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Changing a number format changes appearance without changing the underlying numeric value. IDs preserve required leading zeroes. Dates sort as dates rather than arbitrary text.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Format a valid Excel date as a readable date, 1250 as currency/number, 0.10 as 10%, and 00101 as an ID whose leading zeroes are preserved.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

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4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If 10% was typed as text or a number format does not fix the value, inspect the Formula Bar and stored value. Formatting cannot convert every bad text value into a real number/date.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF4 review - Sort and Filter Safely

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

The top filtered record is correct, full-row relationships remain intact, and clearing the filter restores the original number of records.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Filter an order list to Cash only, sort Amount high-to-low, identify the top visible Order ID, then clear the filter and confirm all rows return.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

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4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If values no longer match their IDs/customers, undo immediately and restore from the working/raw copy. Always select the whole data region or use a Table before sorting.

5. Fresh retry rule

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EF5 review - Formula Basics and Arithmetic

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Formulas reference the intended cells, copied rows adjust correctly, outputs change after an input changes, and one row can be recomputed manually.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

For Quantity in B12 and Unit Price in C12, Revenue = B12*C12. If Cost is D12, Profit = E12-D12. Margin = F12/E12 and display as Percentage.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

Example formula pattern: Revenue = QuantityCell*UnitPriceCell; Profit = RevenueCell-CostCell; Margin = ProfitCell/RevenueCell. Changing an input must update dependent results.

4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If copied formulas point to the wrong row, inspect the Formula Bar. If a displayed percentage is huge, check whether you divided in the correct direction and formatted the result as Percentage.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF6 review - Essential Functions: SUM, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX and COUNT

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

The range boundaries are correct; COUNT matches the number of numeric cells; the total reconciles to an independent subtotal/manual check.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

For B12:B19, enter SUM, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX and COUNT. Read each function in plain English before trusting the result.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

Formula patterns: =SUM(range), =AVERAGE(range), =MIN(range), =MAX(range), =COUNT(range). Check both range endpoints.

4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If a function ignores expected cells, inspect the range endpoints and whether values are numeric. Do not widen the range blindly if headers or unrelated totals are nearby.

5. Fresh retry rule

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EF7 review - Cell References: Relative and Absolute

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Copied formulas use each row input but keep the one shared setting fixed. You can predict the next formula before copying.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

If C13 is Price and H11 is one Discount Rate, use $=C13*H\$11$. Copy one row down: C13 should move to C14 while $H\$11$ remains fixed.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

Shared setting pattern: row input stays relative; shared rate stays absolute, for example $=AmountCell*H\$23$. Predict the copied reference before fill-down.

4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If the fixed setting changes row-by-row, add the correct \$ anchors. If everything is anchored, remove \$ from references that are supposed to move.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF8 review - Excel Tables

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

The object is a real Excel Table with the required name, filters work, a new row belongs to the Table, and you can explain that a Table does not guarantee data quality.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Convert a clean range to a Table, confirm headers, name it DemoOrders, filter it, then add one row directly below and observe expansion.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

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4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If you only changed colors/borders, you did not create a Table. Use Insert > Table or Ctrl+T on the whole clean range, confirm headers, then set the Table Name.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Change the dataset/context. Reproduce the skill without reopening the answer. Append the retry as a new row in Evidence_Log. Only the fresh retry can upgrade mastery.

EF9 review - Basic Charts for Clear Comparison

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

The chart source range is correct, category/time order is correct, title is meaningful, no unnecessary 3D effects are used, and your sentence describes rather than invents a cause.

2. Expected approach / worked reasoning

Create a column chart for revenue by region. Then create a line chart for monthly revenue Jan-Jun and give it a meaningful title.

3. Key answer / reasoning checkpoint

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4. Likely repair if your attempt differed

If categories/values are swapped or the chart tells the wrong relationship, check the source range and chart type. If the sentence claims a cause, rewrite it as an observed pattern only.

5. Fresh retry rule

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M-XLF Integration Mini-Lab review

1. Expected build

One row = one order. Revenue = Quantity * Unit Price using cell references. Use five basic functions on Revenue. Convert the record block to a real named Table. Use safe sort/filter. Create one basic chart. Save one manual row check.

2. Validation

Recalculate one Revenue row manually. Verify the summary formulas cover exactly the Revenue rows. Clear filters and confirm the original record count. Check the chart source and labels.

3. If it failed

Return only to the weak EF lesson: formula/reference problem -> EF5/EF7; range/function problem -> EF6; Table problem -> EF8; chart problem -> EF9; row integrity -> EF4.

4. Fresh retry

Use a changed 8-12 row dataset and rebuild the same competency chain without this review open. Save evidence before Gate A.